

Edtech-University Collaborations

Edtech platforms are tying up with top B-schools and universities across the globe

- **Emeritus**
IIM Calcutta
INSEAD
- **Great Learning**
Deakin University
IIT Bombay
- **upGrad**
Deakin Business School
IIM Kozhikode
IIT Bombay
- **Hero Vired**
University of Chicago
INSEAD
- **Simplilearn**
The Wharton School of the University of Pennsylvania
IIT Roorkee
IIT Kanpur
- **Imarticus**
IIM Lucknow

INCLUDES BLENDED COURSES
SOURCE TRACXN, BT RESEARCH

Eager Investors

Start-ups offering online executive courses and upskilling programmes have been attracting VC funding

Edtech	Key investors	Total funding
● Eruditus Group (includes Emeritus)	CPP Investments	1,200
	Accel	
	SoftBank	
	Prosus	
● upGrad	Temasek	431
	Bodhi Tree	
	IFC	
● Simplilearn	GSV Ventures	80.3
	Clal Insurance	
	DisruptAD	
● Hero Vired	Hero Group	18
● Edusys	Innoven Capital	9.4
	Peak XV Partners	
● Imarticus	Caspian	6.5
	Graffiti Investments	
	CBA Capital	

*FIGURES IN \$ MILLION SOURCE TRACXN, BT RESEARCH

workforce. “There’s a lot more people at lower levels than at higher levels. So, in India [in the near future], two-thirds [of courses] will be tech-oriented, and one-third business-oriented.”

The boom in the space is reflected in the funding these edtech platforms have received. Per data from market intelligence platform Tracxn, the Eruditus Group (which includes its online business Emeritus), has raised \$1.2 billion from marquee investors such as CPP Investments, SoftBank, Accel, Peak XV Ventures (formerly known as Sequoia Capital) and more. And upGrad has raised \$431 million from Temasek, IIFL Finance, Kaizen Management Advisors, and others till date. (See chart ‘Eager Investors’)

Indian edtech players believe the Indian online

executive education industry is set to become bigger. But how do the recruiters view it?

THE RECRUITERS

Ashwin Damera, Co-founder and CEO of Eruditus and Emeritus, says there has been a noticeable trend in hiring candidates with online degrees or certifications in two specific areas. The first, he explains, focusses on programmes such as digital marketing, project management, product management, cybersecurity, and data science/AI, among others, which are typically targeted at individuals with three to eight years of experience. The second is geared towards professionals with 10-15 years of experience who undergo a C-suite programme—that emphasises soft skills or leadership